

	Shabbat, environmental laws	Articles of belief		Resurrection of body
laism	Concept of Promised Land Holocaust – Stewardship	Different groups within Judaism – Orthodoxy, Neo-Orthodoxy, Conservative, Reform, Progressive, Liberal Ashkenazi and Sephardi Jews	Post – Holocaust theology Identity, belonging Zionism, Anti-semitism and family life	Concept of Messianic Hope Twentieth – century Holocaust Post – Holocaust theology
	Concept of deity	Authority and truth in religion	Experience and religion	The Human Condition

4.6 Assessment Availability

There are two examination series each year, in January and June.

In 2009 only AS units will be assessed.

From 2010 onwards, both AS units and A2 units will be assessed.

4.7 Assessment Objectives

Candidates are expected to demonstrate the following in the context of the content described:

AO1 Demonstrate Knowledge and Understanding

- select and demonstrate clearly relevant knowledge and understanding through the use of evidence, examples and correct language and terminology appropriate to the course of study. In addition, for synoptic assessment, A Level candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the connections between different elements of their course of study.

AO2 Analysis, Evaluation and Application

- critically evaluate and justify a point of view through the use of evidence and reasoned argument. In addition, for synoptic assessment, A Level candidates should relate elements of their course of study to their broader context and to aspects of human experience.

AO weightings in AS GCE

Unit	% of AS GCE		
	AO1	AO2	Total
G571: AS <i>Philosophy of Religion</i>	70	30	100
G572: AS <i>Religious Ethics</i>	70	30	100
G573: AS <i>Jewish Scriptures</i>	70	30	100
G574: AS <i>New Testament</i>	70	30	100
G575: AS <i>Developments in Christian Theology</i>	70	30	100
G576: AS <i>Buddhism</i>	70	30	100
G577: AS <i>Hinduism</i>	70	30	100

AO weightings in Advanced GCE

	AO1	AO2	Total
G571 AS <i>Philosophy of Religion</i>	35	15	50
G572: AS <i>Religious Ethics</i>	35	15	50
G573: AS <i>Jewish Scriptures</i>	35	15	50
G574: AS <i>New Testament</i>	35	15	50
G575: AS <i>Developments in Christian Theology</i>	35	15	50
G576: AS <i>Buddhism</i>	35	15	50
G577: AS <i>Hinduism</i>	35	15	50
G578: AS <i>Islam</i>	35	15	50
G579: AS <i>Judaism</i>	35	15	50
G581: A2 <i>Philosophy of Religion</i>	30	20	50
G582: A2 <i>Religious Ethics</i>	30	20	50
G583: A2 <i>Jewish Scriptures</i>	30	20	50
G584: A2 <i>New Testament</i>	30	20	50
G585: A2 <i>Developments in Christian Theology</i>	30	20	50
G586: A2 <i>Buddhism</i>	30	20	50
G587: A2 <i>Hinduism</i>	30	20	50
G588: A2 <i>Islam</i>	30	20	50
G589: A2 <i>Judaism</i>	30	20	50
	65%	35%	100%

4.8 Quality of Written Communication

Quality of Written Communication is assessed in all units and credit may be restricted if communication is unclear.

Candidates will:

- ensure that text is legible and that spelling, punctuation and grammar are accurate so that meaning is clear;
- select and use a form and style of writing appropriate to purpose and to complex subject matter;
- organise information clearly and coherently, using specialist vocabulary when appropriate.

5.1 Making Unit Entries

Please note that centres must be registered with OCR in order to make any entries, including estimated entries. It is recommended that centres apply to OCR to become a registered centre well in advance of making their first entries. Centres must have made an entry for a unit in order for OCR to supply the appropriate forms or moderator details for coursework.

It is essential that unit entry codes (the four-figure alphanumeric codes given in brackets at the end of the unit title) are quoted in all correspondence with OCR. See Sections 4.1 and 4.2 for these unit entry codes.

5.2 Making Qualification Entries

Candidates must enter for qualification certification separately from unit assessment(s). If a certification entry is **not** made, no overall grade can be awarded.

Candidates may enter for:

- AS GCE certification (entry code H172).
- Advanced GCE certification (entry code H572).

A candidate who has completed all the units required for the qualification may enter for certification either in the same examination series (within a specified period after publication of results) or in a later series.

AS GCE certification is available from June 2009.
Advanced GCE certification is available from June 2010.

5.3 Grading

All GCE units are awarded a–e. The Advanced Subsidiary GCE is awarded on the scale A–E. The Advanced GCE is awarded on the scale A–E with access to an A*. To be awarded an A*, candidates will need to achieve a grade A on their full A level qualification and an A* on the aggregate of their A2 units. Grades are reported on certificates. Results for candidates who fail to achieve the minimum grade (E or e) will be recorded as *unclassified* (U or u) and this is **not** certificated.

(UMS) enables comparison of candidates' performance across units. It enables candidates' scores to be put on a common scale for aggregation. Unit AS GCE has a total of 200 *uniform* marks and the four-unit Advanced GCE has a total of 800 *uniform* marks.

The *raw* mark for each unit is converted to a *uniform* mark. The maximum *uniform* mark for each unit is determined by the unit's weighting in the specification. In these Religious Studies specifications, the four-unit Advanced GCE specification has UMS weightings of 25% (and the two-unit specification has UMS weightings of 25%/25%). The UMS totals are then used to ensure that each unit's *raw* mark grade boundary equates to the *uniform* mark boundary. Intermediate marks are converted on a pro-rata basis.

Unit *raw* marks correspond to *unit* grades as follows:

Maximum Unit Uniform Mark	Unit Grade				
	a	b	c	d	e
100	100–80	79–70	69–60	59–50	49–40

The *raw* unit *uniform* marks are compared to these pre-set boundaries (see table 1) to determine the *unit* grade. The *unit* grade is then compared to the boundaries for *qualification* grades.

The *unit* grades correspond to *qualification* grades.

Qualification Grade				
A	B	C	D	E
200–160	159–140	139–120	119–100	99–80
400–320	319–280	279–240	239–200	199–160

Candidates must achieve at least 320 UMS marks in their Advanced GCE, ie grade A, and will receive an A* grade if they achieve at least 400 UMS marks in their two A2 units.

Enquiries and Appeals

In certain circumstances, a centre may wish to query the grade available to one or more candidates. It may also wish to appeal against an outcome of such an enquiry. Enquiries about results should be made immediately following the series in which the relevant unit was taken.

For information on enquiries on results and appeals, centres should consult the OCR *Specification for General Qualifications* and the document *Enquiries about Results and Guidance for Centres* produced by the Joint Council. Copies of these papers can be obtained from OCR.

5.5 Shelf-Life of Units

Individual unit results, prior to certification of the qualification, have a shelf-life limited only by that of the qualification.

5.6 Unit and Qualification Re-sits

There is no restriction on the number of times a candidate may re-sit each unit before entering for certification for an AS GCE or Advanced GCE.

Candidates may enter for the full qualifications an unlimited number of times.

5.7 Guided Learning Hours

AS GCE Religious Studies requires **180** guided learning hours in total.

Advanced GCE Religious Studies requires **360** guided learning hours in total.

5.8 Code of Practice/Subject Criteria/Common Criteria Requirements

These specifications comply in all respects with current *GCSE GCE GNVQ and AEA Code of Practice* as available on the QCA website, the subject criteria for GCE Religious Studies and *The Statutory Regulation of External Qualifications 2004*.

5.9 Arrangements for Candidates with Particular Requirements

For candidates who are unable to complete the full assessment or whose performance may be adversely affected through no fault of their own, teachers should consult the *Access Arrangements and Special Consideration: Regulations and Guidance Relating to Candidates who are Eligible for Adjustments in Examinations* produced by the Joint Council. In such cases advice should be sought from OCR as early as possible during the course.

5.10 Prohibited Qualifications and Classification Code

Candidates who enter for the OCR GCE specifications may not also enter for any other GCE specification with the certification title *Religious Studies* in the same examination series.

Every specification is assigned to a national classification code indicating the subject area to which it belongs.

Centres should be aware that candidates who enter for more than one GCE qualification with the same classification code will have only one grade (the highest) counted for the purpose of the Schools and College Achievement and Attainment Tables.

The classification code for these specifications is 4610.

5.11 Coursework Administration/Regulations

There is no coursework for this specification.

6.1 Overlap with other Qualifications

There is a small degree of overlap between the content GCE Critical Thinking Unit 3 Resolution of Dilemmas which focuses on religious ethics.

6.2 Progression from these Qualifications

This specification provides a suitable foundation for the further study of Religious Studies, Philosophy or Theology. As with any subject in the area of Humanities, students acquire a great range of skills, such as analysis, interpretation, critical thinking and the ability to produce extended evaluative pieces of writing. These are skills that will prepare students well for a range of courses in higher education and, beyond that, in employment generally.

Key Skills Mapping

These specifications provide opportunities for the development of the Key Skills of *Communication of Number*, *Information Technology*, *Working with Others*, *Improving Own Performance* and *Problem Solving* at Levels 2 and/or 3. However, the extent to which the Key Skills criteria at these levels will be totally dependent on the style of teaching adopted for each unit.

The following table indicates where opportunities *may* exist for at least some coverage of the Key Skills criteria at Levels 2 and/or 3 for each unit.

Unit	Communication of Number				Information Technology			Working with Others			Improving Own Performance		
	2.1a	2.1b	2.2	2.3	2.1	2.2	2.3	2.1	2.2	2.3	2.1	2.2	2.3
Unit 1	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 2	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 3	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 4	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 5	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 6	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 7	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 8	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 9	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 10	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 11	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 12	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 13	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 14	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 15	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 16	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 17	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 18	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 19	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unit 20	✓	✓	✓	✓				✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

6.4 Spiritual, Moral, Ethical, Social, Legislative, Economic and Cultural Issues

These specifications offer opportunities which can contribute to an understanding of these issues in the following topics:

Spiritual, Moral, Ethical, Social and Cultural issues are covered in all units within the specifications.

Economic and Legislative issues are covered in particular in Religious Ethics Units at AS and A2.

Religious Studies enables candidates to develop their understanding of spiritual, moral, ethical, social and cultural issues in considerable depth. All modules address at least one of these areas directly. Candidates learn about the nature of spiritual issues and have the opportunity to consider some responses to spiritual questions. Those taking units in Religious Ethics develop an understanding of the bases of morality and ethics and consider a variety of responses to ethical issues. Candidates who study the Developments in Christian Theology units or any of the Textual or World Religions modules also deepen their understanding of the ways in which culture shapes and is shaped by religious belief.

6.5 Sustainable Development, Health and Safety Considerations and European Developments

These specifications support these issues, consistent with current EU agreements, in the following topics:

Environmental education is supported within the Religious Ethics unit at A2.

Health education is supported in the Practical Ethics section of Religious Ethics at AS and A2.

European Developments is supported through topics in the study of religious ethics – medical ethics, environment and business ethics. Similarly the study of World Religions will explore religious practice in a multicultural society.

6.6 Avoidance of Bias

OCR has taken great care in the preparation of these specifications and assessment materials to avoid bias of any kind.

6.7 Language

6.8 Disability Discrimination Act Information Relating to these Specifications

AS/A levels often require assessment of a broad range of competences. This is because they are general qualifications and, as such, prepare candidates for a wide range of occupations and higher level courses.

The revised AS/A level qualification and subject criteria were reviewed to identify whether any of the competences required by the subject presented a potential barrier to any disabled candidates. If this was the case, the situation was reviewed again to ensure that such competences were included only where essential to the subject. The findings of this process were discussed with disability groups and with disabled people.

Reasonable adjustments are made for disabled candidates in order to enable them to access the assessments. For this reason, very few candidates will have a complete barrier to any part of the assessment. Information on reasonable adjustments is found in *Access Arrangements and Special Consideration Regulations and Guidance Relating to Candidates who are Eligible for Adjustments in Examinations* produced by the Joint Council (refer to Section 5.9 of this specification).

Candidates who are still unable to access a significant part of the assessment, even after exploring all possibilities through reasonable adjustments, may still be able to receive an award. They would be given a grade on the parts of the assessment they have taken and there would be an indication on their certificate that not all of the competences have been addressed. This will be kept under review and may be amended in the future.

Performance descriptions have been created for all GCE subjects. They describe the learning outcomes and levels of attainment likely to be demonstrated by a representative candidate performing at the A/B and E/U boundaries for AS and A2.

In practice most candidates will show uneven profiles across the attainments listed, with strengths in some areas compensating in the award process for weaknesses or omissions elsewhere. Performance descriptions illustrate expectations at the A/B and E/U boundaries of the AS and A2 as a whole; they have not been written at unit level.

Grade A/B and E/U boundaries should be set using professional judgement. The judgement should reflect the quality of candidates' work, informed by the available technical and statistical evidence. Performance descriptions are designed to assist examiners in exercising their professional judgement. They should be interpreted and applied in the context of individual specifications and their associated units. However, performance descriptions are not designed to define the content of specifications and units.

The requirement for all AS and A level specifications to assess candidates' quality of written communication will be met through one or more of the assessment objectives.

The performance descriptions have been produced by the regulatory authorities in collaboration with the awarding bodies.

Assessment descriptions for Religious Studies

Assessment objective 1	Assessment objective 2
Select and demonstrate clearly relevant knowledge and understanding through the use of evidence, examples, and correct language and terminology appropriate to the course of study. In addition, for synoptic assessment, A level candidates should demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the connections between different elements	Critically evaluate and justify a point of view through the use of evidence and reasoned argument. In addition, for synoptic assessment, A level candidates should relate elements of their course of study to their broader context and to wider aspects of human experience.